Year 10 Admission Assessment

Version 3, October 2026

Name	
Date	

Welcome

These activities help us get to know you.

Do your best.

It is fine if you cannot answer every question.

Your teacher will tell you when to start each part.

How to answer

Tick one box.

Which one is a fruit? a chair ☐ an apple ☑ a bus ☐

Write your answer in the box.

12 + 8 = **20**

Show your working. You can get marks for your working, even if your answer is wrong.

Working

4 × 25 = 100, 100 + 30 = 130

The parts of this paper

Part	What you do	Time
Listening	Listen to two talks. Answer 16 questions.	15 minutes
Reading	Read three texts. Answer the questions.	12 minutes
Writing	Write a description or an article.	10 minutes
Break		3 to 5 minutes
Maths	Number problems, word problems and pictures.	20 minutes
Science	Questions with pictures, tables and graphs.	8 minutes

You may use a pencil, a rubber and a ruler.

You may **not** use a calculator.

Listening

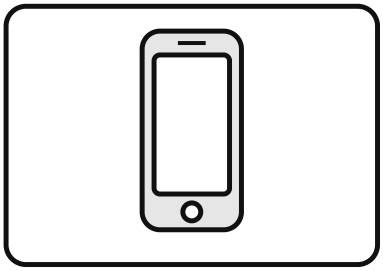
There are two parts: **A** and **B**.
Your teacher will read each part **two times**.
Listen carefully.
Before each part, you have one minute to read the questions.
You can answer while you listen, or after.

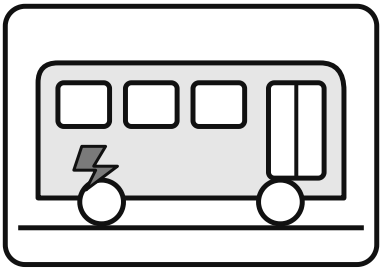
Part A

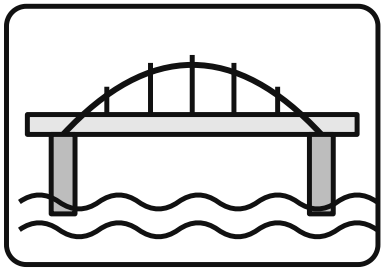
You will hear a short talk. **Answer** questions 1 to 8.

1 / 1

What does Dr Liu's company design?
Tick one picture.


A ☐


B ☐


C ☐

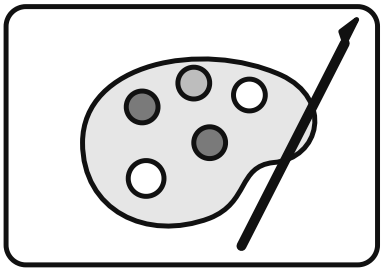
2 / 1

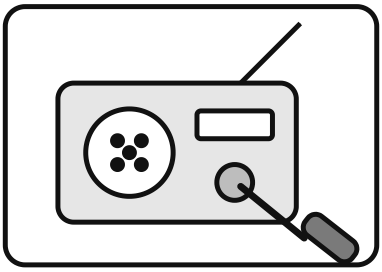
What was Dr Liu's favourite subject at school?
Tick one.

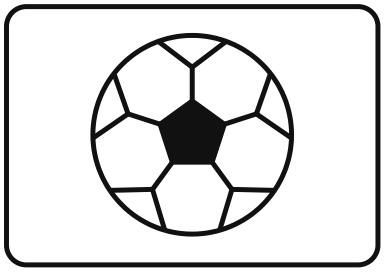
☐ Art ☐ Maths ☐ Physics

3 / 1

What did Dr Liu do at the weekends when she was young?
Tick one picture.


A ☐


B ☐


C ☐

4 / 1

How many years did she study at university? ☐

5 / 1

How many people are in her team? ☐

6 / 1

How far can the newest bus travel before it needs charging? ☐ km

7 / 1

Dr Liu says, "My parents weren't always happy about that!"
Why do you think her parents were not happy?

8 / 1

Why does Dr Liu tell the students that her first battery design failed every test?

Part B

You will hear a talk by **Professor Zhou Lan**. She is a scientist who studies the climate of cities.
Your teacher will read the talk **two times**.
You have one minute to read questions 9 to 16 first.

9 / 1

In the largest cities, on the hottest nights, how much warmer can the city centre be than the countryside?

[ ] degrees

10 and 11 / 2

Complete the notes. **Write** one to three words in each gap.

Example: Roads, concrete and dark roofs absorb the sun's energy in the day. They release it after [**sunset**].

Notes: why are cities hotter?

10 Plants cool the air. Water travels up from the soil, [ ] from the leaves and carries heat away.

11 Waste heat comes from traffic and from [ ].

12 / 1

A green roof has four layers.
Write 1, 2, 3 and 4 to show the order of the layers. 1 is the **bottom** layer.

Layer	Order
soil	[ ]
plants	[ ]
a waterproof layer	[ ]
a drainage layer	[ ]

13 / 1

Professor Zhou's team tested two roofs on a July afternoon.
What temperature did the surface of the **dark** roof reach? [ ] °C

14 / 1

Professor Zhou talks about a "vicious circle".

Explain how a green roof on a building could help to break this circle.

15 / 1

Builders often say that green roofs are too expensive.

What does Professor Zhou think about this? **Tick** one.

- ☐ She agrees that green roofs cost too much to build.
- ☐ She thinks they forget the cost of a city that is too hot.
- ☐ She thinks they should build white roofs instead.
- ☐ She thinks they do not know how green roofs are built.

16 / 1

What is the main purpose of Professor Zhou's talk? **Tick** one.

- ☐ To warn that cities will soon be too hot for people to live in.
- ☐ To explain a problem in cities and suggest how the school could help.
- ☐ To show that green roofs are cheaper than white roofs in the end.
- ☐ To report the results of her team's research in Hangzhou.

Reading

There are three parts: **A**, **B** and **C**.
Each part is harder than the one before.
Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish.
You have 12 minutes. When you finish, wait for your teacher.

Part A

Read the menu. Then **answer** questions 1 to 7.

Lotus Café

Fresh noodles, rice and snacks, made every day

Opening hours
Monday to Friday: 7:30 to 20:00
Saturday and Sunday: 9:00 to 21:00

Noodles and rice

Beef noodle soup	spicy	¥32
Tomato and egg noodles	vegetarian	¥24
Chicken fried rice		¥28
Vegetable fried rice	vegetarian	¥22
Spicy tofu with rice	vegetarian, spicy	¥26

Snacks

Pork dumplings (8)		¥18
Spring rolls (4)	vegetarian	¥15

Drinks

Milk tea	¥14
Orange juice	¥16
Water	¥5

Key
vegetarian (no meat or fish)
spicy

Student deal
Any noodle dish
+ any drink = ¥35
Monday to Friday, 14:00 to 17:00
Show your student card.

Allergies?
Please tell our staff before you order.

1 / 1

What time does the café open on Sunday? _____

2 / 1

How much is the beef noodle soup? ____

3 / 2

Tick the **two** dishes that are vegetarian.

- ☐ Beef noodle soup
- ☐ Tomato and egg noodles
- ☐ Chicken fried rice
- ☐ Spring rolls
- ☐ Pork dumplings

4 / 1

Aisha is vegetarian. She does not like spicy food.

Write one dish from "Noodles and rice" that she can choose.

____

5 / 1

When can you get the student deal? **Write** the days and the times.

____

6 / 1

What must you show to get the student deal? ____

7 / 1

You have an allergy. What should you do?

____

Part B

Read the story. Then **answer** questions 8 to 15.

The Mooncake Lesson

Sofia had lived in Hangzhou for three months, but she still felt like a visitor.

On the afternoon before the Mid-Autumn Festival, there was a knock at the door. It was Mrs Chen from the flat next door. She was holding a large bag of flour and smiling.

"Your mother says you have never made mooncakes," she said. "Come. I will teach you."

Sofia was not sure. She was terrible at cooking. Last week she had burnt a pan of rice so badly that the whole flat smelt of smoke. But Mrs Chen was already walking back to her door, so Sofia followed.

Mrs Chen's kitchen was small and warm. Her grandson, Jun, was sitting at the table with a wooden mould. He was eleven, and he looked bored. "Grandma makes me help every year," he said.

Mrs Chen showed Sofia how to wrap sweet bean paste in a thin layer of dough. Sofia's first mooncake split open. Her second one was lopsided. Jun laughed, but not unkindly. "Mine looked like that last year," he said. "Press it into the mould. Slowly."

The third mooncake came out perfect, with a flower pattern on top. Sofia stared at it. Then she grinned.

That evening, the three of them sat on the balcony and looked at the full moon. Sofia ate a mooncake she had made herself. It was a little too sweet, but it was the best thing she had eaten since she arrived.

For the first time, Hangzhou felt a little bit like home.

8 / 1

How long had Sofia lived in Hangzhou? _____

9 / 1

What was Mrs Chen holding when she came to the door?

_____

10 / 1

Why was Sofia not sure about making mooncakes?

_____

11 / 1

Why do you think Jun looked bored?

12 / 1

"Jun laughed, but not unkindly."

What does this tell you about Jun?

13 / 1

Write 1, 2, 3 and 4 to show the order of these events. Number 1 is done for you.

Event	Order
The third mooncake came out perfect.	
Mrs Chen knocked on the door.	1
They looked at the full moon.	
Sofia's first mooncake split open.	

14 / 1

Find and **copy** one word that shows Sofia was happy with her third mooncake.

15 / 1

At the end, why did Hangzhou feel "a little bit like home"?

Part C

Read the article. Then **answer** questions 16 to 22.

Ten Minutes of Nothing

By Zhang Yiran, Year 11

When did you last do nothing at all? I do not mean sleeping, and I do not mean scrolling through videos. I mean sitting still, with no screen, no music and no plan, and simply letting your mind wander.

If you are like most teenagers I know, you probably cannot remember. The moment we feel even slightly bored (in a queue, on the bus, while a video is loading) our hands reach for our phones. Boredom feels like a problem, and our phones offer an instant solution.

I would like to suggest that boredom is not a problem at all. In fact, it may be one of the most useful feelings we have.

Psychologists describe boredom as a kind of signal. It tells us that what we are doing is not satisfying, and it pushes us to look for something better. When we fill every empty moment with a screen, we never hear that signal. We stay busy, but we are not really choosing what to do with our time.

There is also evidence that a wandering mind can be a creative one. In one study, a group of adults spent fifteen minutes copying numbers from a long list. Afterwards, they were asked to think of as many uses as possible for two plastic cups. They came up with more ideas than a group who had skipped the boring task. The researchers believe that boredom gives the mind time to make unexpected connections.

Of course, nobody enjoys being bored for hours, and I am not suggesting that we throw our phones into the nearest river. My suggestion is much smaller: try ten minutes of nothing each day. Leave your phone in your bag on the way home. Look out of the window. Notice where your thoughts go.

The first few minutes will feel strange, perhaps even uncomfortable. But you may be surprised by what your mind does when you finally give it some space.

16 / 1

What does the writer say most teenagers do when they feel bored?

17 / 1

What does "instant" mean in "our phones offer an instant solution"? **Tick** one.

☐ expensive ☐ immediate ☐ difficult ☐ boring

18 / 1

According to psychologists, what does boredom tell us?

19 / 1

In the study, what did the bored group do better than the other group?

20 / 2

Tick Fact or Opinion for each sentence.

Example: Hangzhou is a city in China. Fact ☑ Opinion ☐

Sentence	Fact	Opinion
In one study, a group of adults spent fifteen minutes copying numbers.	☐	☐
Boredom is not a problem at all.	☐	☐
The bored group came up with more ideas than the other group.	☐	☐
Boredom may be one of the most useful feelings we have.	☐	☐

21 / 1

"I am not suggesting that we throw our phones into the nearest river."
Why does the writer include this sentence?

22 / 1

The article begins with a question: "When did you last do nothing at all?"
Why do you think the writer begins in this way?

Writing

Choose one task: A or B.

Tick the box for the task you choose.

Plan your ideas in the plan box. Then **write** on the lines.

You have 10 minutes. Write as much as you can.

Task A: a description ☐

Describe a busy place you know well. For example: a market, a train station or a festival.

Help the reader to see, hear and smell the place.

Ideas: the people, the sounds, the smells, the colours, how the place makes you feel.

Task B: an article ☐

Some people say:

> Every student should spend one week each year volunteering in their community, for example in a library, a park or a home for older people.

Do you agree? **Write** an article for the school website. Give your opinion, with reasons and examples.

Plan

Notes and ideas (this part is not marked)

Your writing

Task A ☐ Task B ☐

Maths

You have 20 minutes. Do as much as you can.

Write your answer in the box. **Show** your working in the working box.

Your teacher can read any question to you.

You may **not** use a calculator.

Section A: Number problems

What the maths words mean

Standard form: $3500 = 3.5 \times 10^3$

Expand: $3(x + 2) = 3x + 6$

Make *a* the subject: $b = a + 2$, so $a = b - 2$

Solve: $x + 3 = 10$, so $x = 7$

1 / 1

Work out $-8 - 3 \times (-4)$

2 / 1

Write 4 600 000 in standard form.

3 / 1

Simplify $x^5 \times x^3 \div x^2$

4 / 1

Make x the subject of $y = 3x - 5$

5 / 2

Expand and simplify $(x + 4)(x - 2)$

Working

6 / 2

Solve these simultaneous equations.

$2x + y = 11$

$x - y = 1$

Working

$x =$ ☐ $y =$ ☐

7 / 1

Solve $x^2 - 5x + 6 = 0$

Working

$x =$ ☐ or $x =$ ☐

Section B: Word problems and pictures

8 / 1

A school has 1200 students.

15% of the students come to school by bus.

How many students come to school by bus?

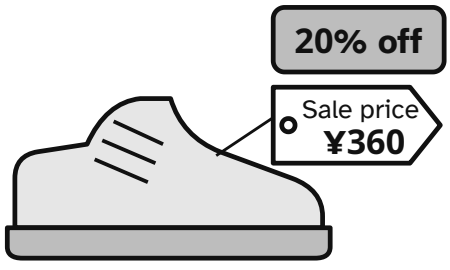
☐

9 / 2

In a sale, all prices go down by 20%.

The sale price of these trainers is ¥360.

What was the price **before** the sale?



Working

¥ ☐

10 / 2

Li Na puts ¥5000 in a bank.
The bank pays 4% compound interest each year.
How much money does she have after 2 years?

Working

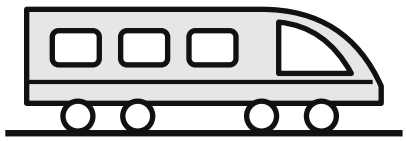
¥

11 / 2

A train leaves Hangzhou at 08:50.

It arrives in Beijing at 13:20.

The train travels 1260 km.



Work out the average speed of the train in km per hour.

Working

km per hour

12 / 2

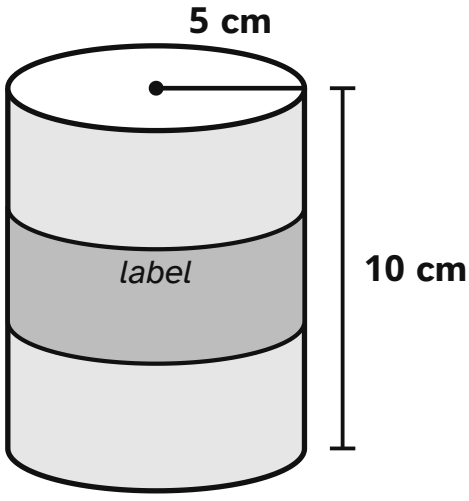
This tin is a cylinder.
The radius is 5 cm. The height is 10 cm.
Use π = 3.14.

(a) The label goes once around the tin.
Work out the length of the label.

cm

(b) **Work out** the volume of the tin.

cm³



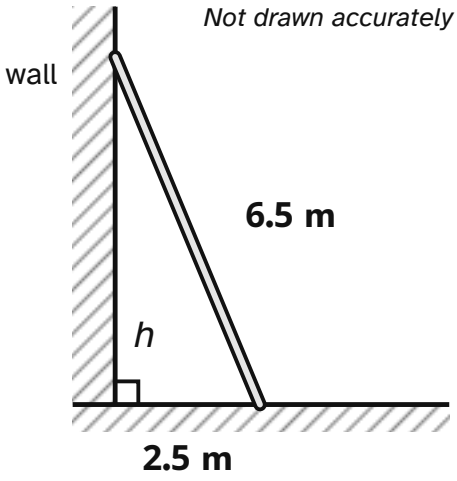
Not drawn accurately

13

/ 2

A ladder is 6.5 m long.
It leans against a wall.
The foot of the ladder is 2.5 m from the wall.

Work out the height, h, that the ladder reaches up the wall.



Working

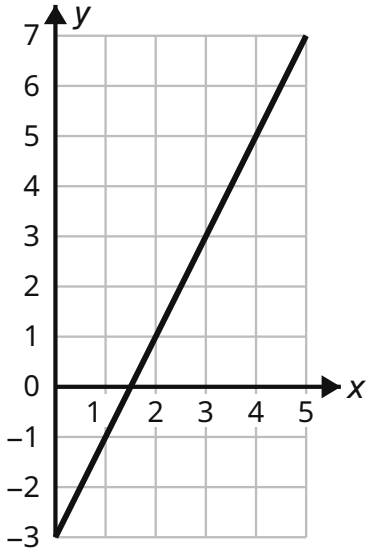
h = ☐ m

14

/ 2

Look at the straight line on the grid.

Write the equation of the line in the form $y = mx + c$.



Working

y = ☐

15

/ 2

20 students say how long their journey to school takes.

Time, t minutes	Number of students
$0 < t \leqslant 10$	4
$10 < t \leqslant 20$	8
$20 < t \leqslant 30$	5
$30 < t \leqslant 40$	3

Work out an estimate of the mean journey time.

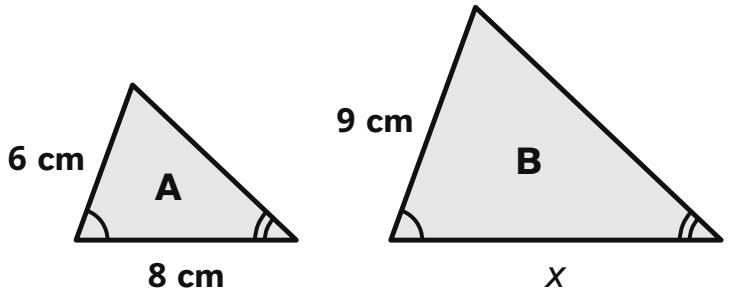
Working

☐ minutes

16 / 2

Triangles A and B are similar. Matching angles are marked.

Not drawn accurately



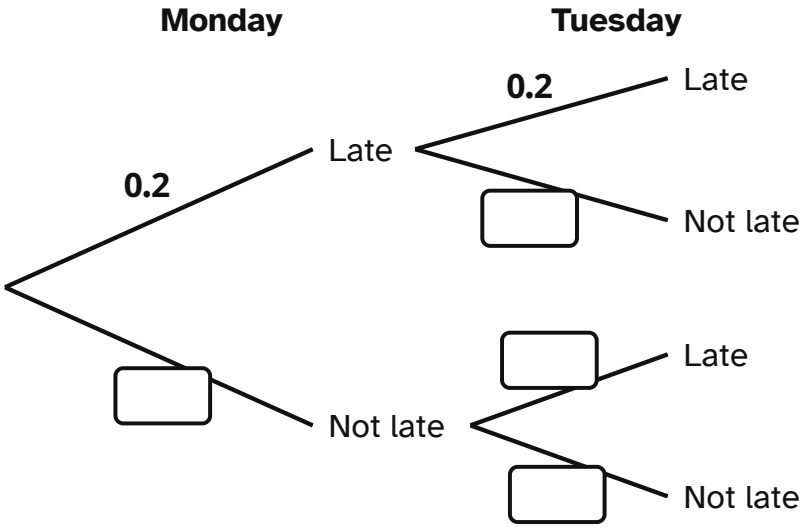
Work out the length *x*.

Working

x = ____ cm

17 / 2

The probability that Jun's bus is late on any day is 0.2.

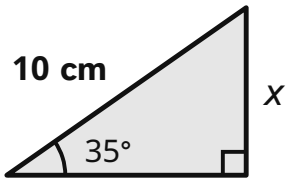


(a) **Complete** the tree diagram. Write a number in each empty box.

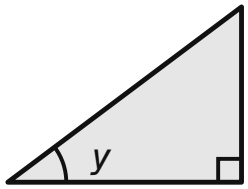
(b) **Work out** the probability that the bus is late on Monday **and** on Tuesday.

18 / 2

Not drawn accurately



A



B

Use these values.

	35°	**37°**	**53°**
sin	0.57	0.60	0.80
cos	0.82	0.80	0.60
tan	0.70	0.75	1.33

(a) **Work out** the length x in triangle A. $x =$ ☐ cm

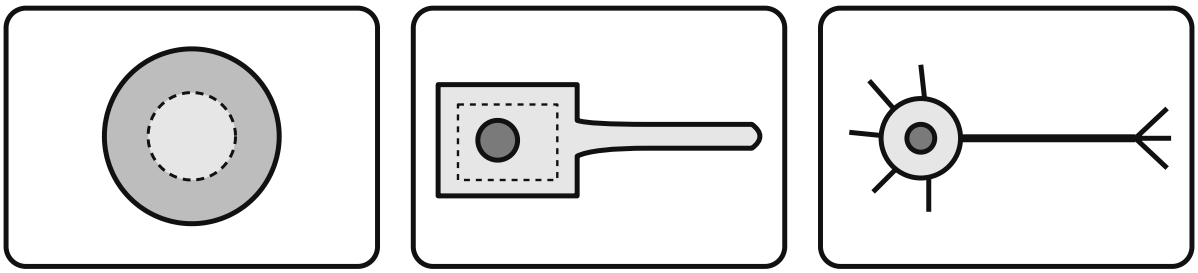
(b) **Work out** the size of angle y in triangle B. $y =$ ☐ °

Science

You have 8 minutes. Do as much as you can.
Your teacher can read any question to you.

1 / 1

These are three specialised cells.

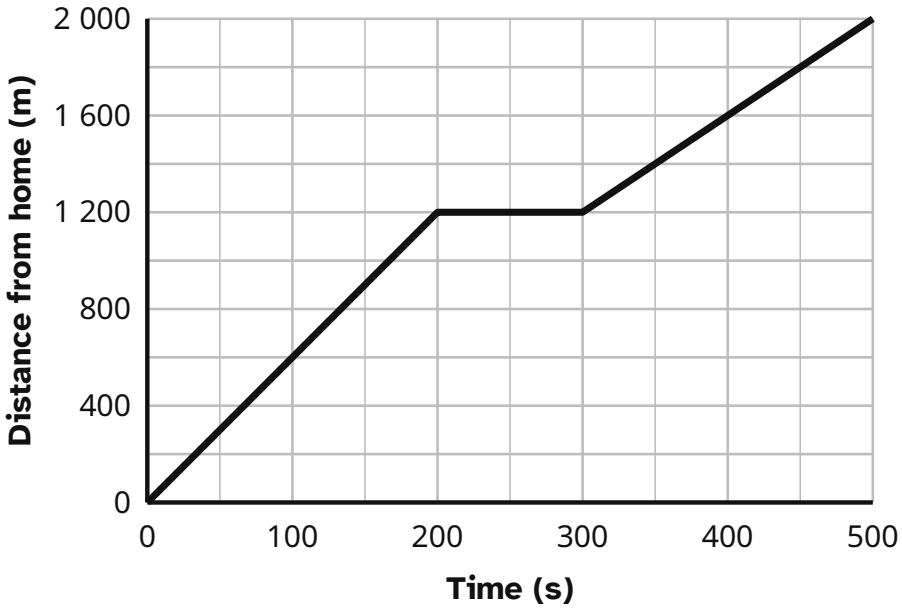


A **B** **C**

Which cell takes in water from the soil? **Write** the letter. ☐

2 / 2

Jun cycles from home to school. This graph shows his journey.



(a) What is Jun doing between 200 s and 300 s? ☐

(b) **Work out** Jun's speed in the first 200 s. Use: speed = distance ÷ time.

☐ m/s

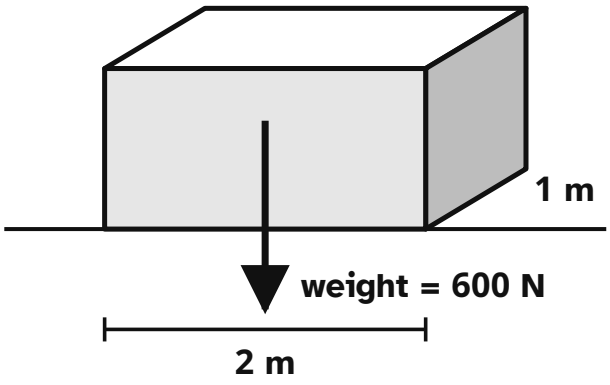
3 / 1

A box weighs 600 N.
Its base is 2 m long and 1 m wide.

Work out the pressure of the box on the floor.

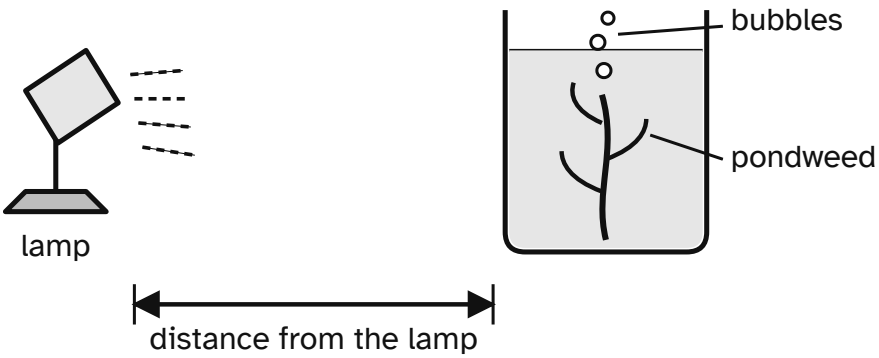
Use: pressure = force ÷ area.

_____ N/m²



4 / 3

Sofia investigates how light affects photosynthesis. She puts a lamp at different distances from some pondweed. She counts the bubbles of gas in one minute.



Distance from the lamp (cm)	**10**	**20**	**30**	**40**
Number of bubbles in one minute	52	31	17	9

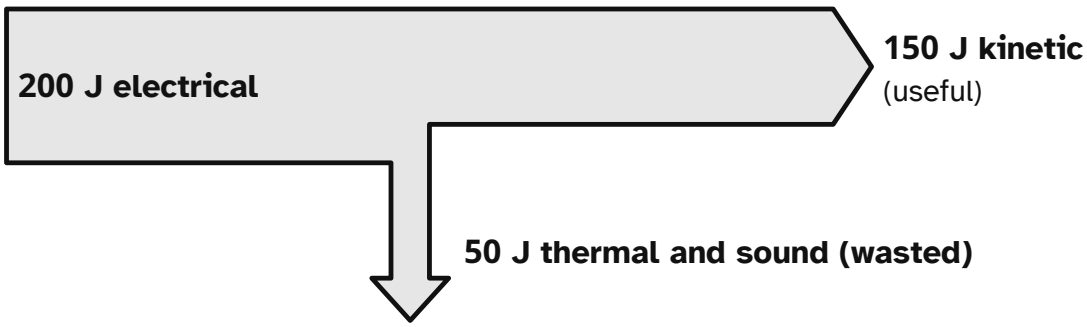
(a) **Describe** the pattern in the results.

(b) **Write** one variable Sofia must keep the same.

(c) Sofia counted the bubbles only once at each distance. **Suggest** one way to improve her method.

5 / 1

This diagram shows the energy transfers in an electric fan.

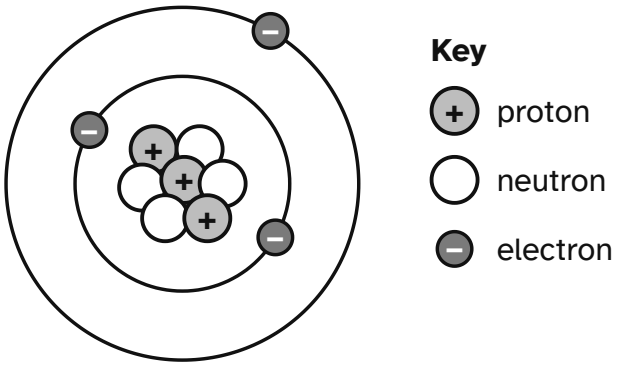


Work out the efficiency of the fan. Use: efficiency = useful energy out ÷ total energy in.

6 / 1

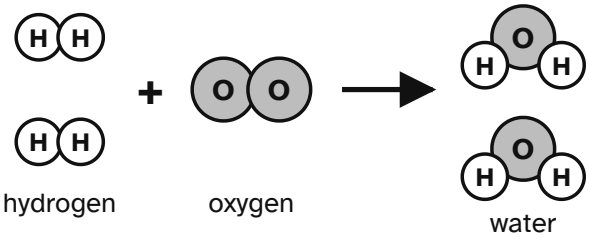
This diagram shows an atom.

What is the **mass number** of this atom?



7 / 1

Hydrogen reacts with oxygen to make water.



Write the missing number to balance the equation.

$$\square\ H_2 + O_2 \rightarrow 2H_2O$$

Thank you. You have finished. Please wait for your teacher.

> **Version 3, October 2026: version 1 with the version 2 listening** (Parts A and B, 16 marks, version 2 band guide). Reading, writing, maths and science are version 1, unchanged. Use only with `Y10_Student_Paper_v3`.

Year 10 Admission Assessment v3: assessor booklet

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Year group applied for	
Current school	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

Who this is for. Students applying for **Year 10** (age 14 on 1 September), the first year of a **two-year IGCSE course**. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 8 (初二)**; a student joining mid-year is partway through Grade 9 (初三). Ask the student and the family which grade and which textbooks they have used, because the order of topics differs between textbooks and regions. Background on Chinese school sequences, the English bands and the decision guide is in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

What it measures. The student's level of English in listening, reading, writing and speaking (bands A to E), their maths and science against the end of Key Stage 3 (the UK Year 9 curriculum), and, through the interview, who they are, their future plans and their suitability for the programme. Section 6 explains how to read the results together to judge **readiness for IGCSE study in English**.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Print
1	Welcome	2	Assessor		This booklet
2	Listening: Part A (questions 1 to 8) and Part B (questions 9 to 16), 16 marks	15	Assessor reads both scripts (Section 3.1); a small group is fine	Student paper pages 2 to 5; pencil	Student paper
3	Reading paper: Parts A, B and C (24 marks)	12	Student works alone	Student paper pages 6 to 11	
4	Writing: one task from two (16 marks)	10	Student works alone	Student paper pages 12 to 13	
5	Break	3 to 5		Water	
6	Maths: Section A Number problems, Section B Word problems and pictures (30 marks)	20	Student works alone; the assessor may read any question aloud	Student paper pages 14 to 19; pencil, rubber, ruler; **no calculator, no protractor**	
7	Science: 7 questions (10 marks)	8	Student works alone; the assessor may read any question aloud	Student paper pages 20 to 22	
8	Interview, opening with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen at **Level 9**	15	Interviewer, 1:1	Sentence Reading Card (laminated); a plain card to cover sentences	Sentence Reading Record; Interview Record Years 7 to 10
	Total	**about 80 to 85**		A clock or timer	Candidate Summary and Decision

Files: `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record`, `forms/Interview_Record_Y7_Y10`, `forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`.

The parent conversation (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`, about 15 minutes) can run at the same time with another member of staff. The written papers (tasks 2 to 7) can be taken in a small group with one invigilator; the interview is always 1:1.

2. Before you start

Room. Quiet, bright, a clock the student can see, the student paper face down, a pencil, rubber and ruler. Glasses or hearing aids if the student uses them.

Say (welcome): "Hello, I am [name]. Thank you for coming today. These activities help us get to know you, so that we can help you when you join us. Some questions are easy and some are hard. Nobody gets everything right, and that is fine. Do your best. If you do not know an answer, go on to the next question. In the English parts, I can only repeat the instructions. In maths and science, I can read any question to you. Do you have any questions before we start?"

Access rules (the same in every year group)

	English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	Maths and science
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not read the reading texts or questions aloud, explain words or translate. Instructions may be repeated in English.	Any question may be read aloud in English, as often as the student asks. You may point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student clearly cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Write **L** in the margin. The mark still counts.
Answers	In English only. An answer in Chinese scores 0.	In English only: numbers, words, ticks, drawings and working all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0.
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List NT topics in the score summary.

Extra time, a reader or other arrangements for a known need are allowed: record them in the score summary.

Stopping rules

- The student may stop any section when they have done what they can. Say: "That is fine. Thank you. We will go on to the next part."
- **Listening:** if the student scores 2 or fewer out of 8 in Part A (questions 1 to 8), you may leave out Part B: check Part A quickly in the minute after it. Say: "Thank you. That is the end of the listening." Write "Part B not given" in the score summary; the band then comes from Part A alone (band A). In a group, read Part B to everyone as usual; a student with 2 or fewer in Part A may sit quietly.
- **Reading paper:** if the student cannot answer any of Part A after about 4 minutes, let them stop and record it. Do not move them on to Parts B and C.
- **Writing:** if the student has written nothing in English after 3 minutes, say once: "Write anything you can in English: a few words or sentences about yourself is fine." Then let them stop when they wish.
- **Maths and science:** encourage the student to look at every page, because later questions on different topics may be easier for them. Do not stop early unless the student is distressed.
- If a student becomes upset at any point, stop, take a break, and continue only if they are happy to. Record it.

Keeping the student at ease. Smile, use the student's name, and keep your voice calm. Do not say "right" or "wrong" during the tasks; say "thank you" instead. Give a two-minute warning before the end of the reading paper, maths and science. A student who finishes early may check their work quietly.

3. English

3.1 Listening (16 marks: Part A 8, Part B 8)

There are two parts, and you read each one twice. **Part A** is the version 1 careers day talk, unchanged: everyday listening. **Part B** is a short lesson-style talk with subject vocabulary, statistics, a correction and an implied opinion: the listening that IGCSE lessons need, at the level of a fluent speaker of 14 to 15.

Part A. Say: "Turn to the Listening page. There are two parts. In Part A, you will hear a short talk by an engineer on a careers day at a school. I will read it two times. First, you have one minute to read questions 1 to 8." Wait one minute. **Say:** "Now listen." Read the Part A script. Wait 10 seconds. **Say:** "Now listen again." Read it again. Then give the student one more minute to finish.

Part B. Say: "Now turn to Part B, on page 4. You will hear a talk by a scientist, Professor Zhou Lan, about the climate of cities. I will read it two times. First, you have one minute to read questions 9 to 16." Wait one minute. **Say:** "Now listen." Read the Part B script. Wait 10 seconds. **Say:** "Now listen again." Read it again. Then give the student one more minute to finish.

Read both scripts twice at a natural, steady pace (about the speed of a teacher talking to a class, about 150 words a minute). At each [pause], stop for about 3 seconds. Do not slow down for key words, repeat sentences or explain anything. Read Part B at the same pace as Part A: it is meant to sound like a lesson.

Timing. Each reading of Part A takes about 2 minutes and each reading of Part B about 3.5 minutes, so the four readings take about 11 minutes. With one minute to read each set of questions, the two short gaps and one minute to finish each part, **allow about 15 minutes** for the listening.

Script, Part A: Careers Day talk

Good morning, everyone. My name is Dr Liu Yan, and I'm an engineer. I work for a company in Shenzhen that designs electric buses. Some of you probably came to school on one of our buses this morning. [pause]

When I was your age, I wasn't sure what I wanted to do. I was quite good at art, and I loved drawing. But my favourite subject was physics, because I always wanted to know how things worked. At the weekends, I took old radios apart and tried to put them back together. [pause]

After school, I studied engineering at university for four years. Then I worked in a battery factory for two years. Now I lead a team of twelve people. [pause] Our newest bus can travel three hundred kilometres before it needs charging, and it charges in about ninety minutes. [pause]

People often think engineers sit alone at a computer all day. In fact, I spend most of my time talking: to my team, to bus drivers, and to the people who use our buses. Last year, an older passenger told us the steps were too high. So we changed the design. Now the floor of the bus goes down when it stops. [pause]

My advice to you is simple. Don't be afraid of getting things wrong. I got a lot of things wrong with those old radios. My parents weren't always happy about that! [pause] My first battery design failed every test, too. But each time it failed, I learnt something new. And remember: being good at maths is useful, but being good at listening is just as important. Thank you. [pause]

Part A answers (1 mark each; the same as version 1). Spelling does not matter in listening if the meaning is clear.

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
1	**B** (the bus)		
2	**Physics**		Art (she was good at art, but it was not her favourite); Maths (mentioned only at the end)

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
3	**B** (taking a radio apart)		A (painting: she loved drawing, but that is not what she did at weekends)
4	**4**	four (years)	2 (the years in the battery factory)
5	**12**	twelve	
6	**300** (km)	three hundred	90 (the charging time in minutes)
7	**The radios might be broken, or not work again**	She broke them; she could not always put them back together; she got things wrong with the radios; she made a mess; it could be dangerous; they were worried about the radios	"She did not study"; "She liked art"; an answer about the bus
8	**To show that mistakes help you learn**	Do not be afraid of getting things wrong; failing is part of learning; each failure taught her something; even experts fail at first	"Because the battery was bad" with no idea of learning from it

Script, Part B: a talk about cities and heat

Good afternoon, everyone. My name is Professor Zhou Lan, and I study the climate of cities. [pause]

On a still summer night, a thermometer in a city centre will almost always read higher than one in the fields outside. Scientists call this the urban heat island effect. "Urban" means "to do with cities", and a city really is an island of heat in the cooler countryside. At night, a city centre is about three degrees warmer. Actually, let me correct that: three degrees is only the average, and in the largest cities, on the hottest nights, the difference can reach seven degrees. [pause]

So why does this happen? First, roads, concrete and dark roofs absorb the sun's energy during the day and release it slowly after sunset, so the city never really cools down. Second, cities have far fewer trees and plants, which cool the air through a process called evapotranspiration. It's a long word for a simple idea: water travels up from the soil, evaporates from the leaves and carries heat away, rather like sweat cooling your skin. Third, there is waste heat from traffic and from air conditioners, which pump hot air out into the street. As a result, the hotter the city becomes, the more people switch their air conditioners on, and the hotter the streets get: a vicious circle. [pause]

One solution is the green roof: a roof covered with living plants and built in layers. At the bottom is a waterproof layer that protects the building. Above that is a drainage layer, which allows extra water to flow away. Then comes a thin layer of soil, and finally the plants: tough species that can survive for weeks without rain. [pause]

In 2023, my team tested two roofs side by side on a school in Hangzhou. On a July afternoon, the surface of the ordinary dark roof reached sixty-eight degrees, whereas the green roof stayed at around thirty-one. The classrooms under the green roof were also about four degrees cooler, so the school used noticeably less electricity for air conditioning. [pause]

Green roofs also soak up rainwater like a sponge, which reduces flooding, and they give insects and birds somewhere to live. On the other hand, they are heavier and cost more to build, and builders often tell me they are simply too expensive. I sometimes wonder how much they think a city that is too hot to live in will cost. [pause]

Painting roofs white also helps, because a white surface reflects sunlight rather than absorbing it. However, a white roof doesn't hold any rainwater, and it doesn't give a single butterfly anywhere to live. [pause]

Your sports hall has a large flat roof, and at the moment it is simply collecting heat. I'll leave you to think about what else it could be doing. Thank you. [pause]

Part B answers (1 mark each). Spelling does not matter in listening if the word is recognisable and the meaning is clear. Every answer is said in the script, and the questions follow the order of the script.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
9	Specific detail (a number), after a correction	**7** (degrees)	seven; 7 °C; up to 7	**3**: the average, which she corrects ("Actually, let me correct that: three degrees is only the average"). An answer of 3 shows the student caught the first number but not the correction.
10	Note completion (a process)	**evaporates**	evaporate; evaporating; it evaporates; goes into the air; turns into vapour; recognisable spellings (evaporats, evapourates)	"travels" or "carries heat away" (already in the note); "sweat" (the comparison); "evapotranspiration" (the name of the whole process: the gap needs what the water does).
11	Note completion (a detail)	**air conditioners**	air conditioner; air conditioning; air-con; AC	"traffic" (already in the note); "cars"; "hot air" (what they pump out, not where the waste heat comes from); "the sun".
12	Process or sequence	soil **3**, plants **4**, a waterproof layer **1**, a drainage layer **2**		All four correct for the mark. Waterproof and drainage swapped is the usual error: the student heard the four layers but not "At the bottom … Above that …".
13	Specific detail (a number)	**68** (°C)	sixty-eight	31 (the green roof); 4 (the classrooms were four degrees cooler); 2023 (the year).
14	Inference joining two parts of the talk	**Rooms under a green roof stay cooler, so people use less air conditioning, so less hot air (waste heat) is pumped into the street.**	Any answer that links the green roof to using less air conditioning or less electricity for air conditioning: "the building is cooler, so people do not switch on the air conditioner so much"; "less air conditioning, so the streets do not get hotter"	"It has plants" or "it makes the city cooler" with no link to air conditioning; "it holds rainwater"; "it costs more". The question joins the vicious circle (the third cause) with the school's result (less electricity for air conditioning).
15	Speaker's attitude (implied)	**B**: she thinks they forget the cost of a city that is too hot		A is the opposite of her view; C mixes in the later point about white roofs; D is not said. She never says the builders are wrong: the student must hear the irony in "I sometimes wonder how much they think a city that is too hot to live in will cost."
16	Main idea or speaker's purpose	**B**: to explain a problem in cities and suggest how the school could help		A exaggerates (she does not say cities will soon be too hot to live in); C is not said; D is one part of the talk, not its purpose. The ending ("Your sports hall has a large flat roof … I'll leave you to think about what else it could be doing") carries the suggestion.

What is in the Part B script (for the English team): 465 words in 28 sentences (16.6 words a sentence on average); about 14% of the words are outside the 2000 most common English words (about 20.5% counting each word form separately; `wordfreq` lists, names left out). It explains a process and a chain of cause and effect (three causes, the vicious circle, the layers of a green roof); compares the city with the countryside, a dark roof with a green roof, and a green roof with a white one; gives statistics and a date; explains subject vocabulary in context (urban, the urban heat island effect, evapotranspiration, a drainage layer); corrects a number ("Actually, let me correct that"); implies opinions without stating them (the builders, white roofs, the sports hall); and uses discourse markers (first, second, third, as a result, whereas, on the other hand, however).

Band guide (version 2)

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 2	**A** New to English
Part A 3 to 4	**B** Early acquisition
Part A 5 to 6, or Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 0 to 2	**C** Developing competence
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 3 to 5	**D** Competent
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 6 to 8	**E** Fluent

If the two parts disagree in an unexpected way (for example Part A 5 or 6 with Part B 5 or more), use the interview to decide: the student may have lost easy marks in Part A through nerves or carelessness.

What to look for

- **Part A** checks everyday listening: questions 1 to 3 the main points, 4 to 6 exact details with distractors (two years, ninety minutes), and 7 and 8 implied meaning and the speaker's purpose.
- **Part B** is the step up. Questions 9 to 13 need exact detail from fast, connected speech, with distractors (3 degrees, 31 °C, the order of the layers); questions 14 to 16 need the student to join ideas, hear an attitude that is never stated and see the purpose of the whole talk. A student who gets 9 to 13 but not 14 to 16 follows the content of a lesson but not yet its argument.
- **Part A secure, Part B 0 to 2**: everyday English is fine, but lessons taught only by talk will be hard to follow at first. Plan visual support, key vocabulary in writing and frequent checks for understanding.
- Compare with listening in the interview. If the two differ by more than one band, use the interview as a check.

3.2 Reading paper (12 minutes, 24 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Reading page. There are three parts, A, B and C. Each part is harder. Read the texts yourself. I cannot read them to you or explain words. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 12 minutes." Give a two-minute warning.

General rules. Answers can be in the student's own words or copied from the text, unless the question says "copy". Ignore spelling and grammar unless the answer cannot be understood (except question 14). Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

Part A: café menu (very accessible; picture support)

Q	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
1	9:00	1	9 am; nine o'clock; 9. Do not accept 7:30 (that is Monday to Friday).
2	¥32	1	32; 32 yuan
3	Tomato and egg noodles; Spring rolls	2	1 mark for each correct tick, minus 1 for each wrong tick (minimum 0).
4	Tomato and egg noodles, **or** vegetable fried rice	1	Do not accept spicy tofu with rice (spicy) or spring rolls (a snack, not in "Noodles and rice").
5	Monday to Friday, 14:00 to 17:00	1	weekdays; 2 pm to 5 pm. Days and times both needed.
6	(Your) student card	1	student ID
7	Tell the staff before you order	1	tell the staff; tell the waiter; ask the staff

Part B: "The Mooncake Lesson" (fiction, about two years below age level)

Q	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
8	Three months	1	3 months
9	A (large) bag of flour	1	flour
10	She was terrible at cooking	1	She was bad at cooking; she had burnt the rice.
11	He has to help every year	1	His grandma makes him help; he has done it many times; he did not choose to. Do not accept "he was tired" or "he was sad".

Q	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
12	He was friendly, not making fun of her	1	kind; nice; he was laughing with her, not at her; he wanted to help
13	3, 1, 4, 2 (from the top)	1	All three missing numbers correct.
14	grinned	1	Must be the copied word, spelt correctly. Do not accept "perfect" or "stared".
15	She felt welcome: she had made friends with her neighbours and shared the festival with them	1	Any one idea: new friends; kind neighbours; she belonged or was part of a family celebration; she did something new and it went well. Do not accept "because she ate a mooncake" alone.

Part C: "Ten Minutes of Nothing" (non-fiction opinion article, age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 14)

Q	Skill	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
16	Retrieval	They reach for their phones	1	look at, pick up or use their phones
17	Vocabulary in context	immediate	1	
18	Retrieval and understanding	That what we are doing is not satisfying, so we should look for something better	1	Either idea; "it is a signal to change what we are doing". Do not accept "that we are tired".
19	Retrieval	They thought of more ideas (more uses for the plastic cups)	1	were more creative; had more ideas. Do not accept "they copied numbers".
20	Fact and opinion	Fact, Opinion, Fact, Opinion	2	All four correct: 2. Three correct: 1. Two or fewer: 0.
21	Writer's purpose	To show that her idea is reasonable, not extreme: she is not against phones	1	to answer readers who think she wants to ban phones; to make her small suggestion seem easy; humour to keep the reader on her side, if linked to her point
22	Writer's purpose	To get the reader's attention and make them think about their own life	1	to involve or "hook" the reader; to make readers realise they never do nothing. Do not accept "because it is a question".

Band guide (use judgement when a result is uneven, and check against the sentence reading screen)

Result	Band
Part A under 4	**A** New to English
Part A 4 or more, Part B under 4	**B** Early acquisition
Part B 4 or more, Part C under 3	**C** Developing competence
Part C 3 to 5	**D** Competent
Part C 6 to 8	**E** Fluent

What to look for

- **Strong readers** separate fact from opinion (question 20) and explain why a writer makes a choice (21 and 22). These are the skills IGCSE English and the humanities test most, so a Part C score of 6 or more is the best single sign of readiness for First Language English.
- **An English barrier** looks like: Part A secure, Part B patchy, Part C blank or copied lines that do not answer the question. A student who reads aloud well (sentence reading) but scores low on Parts B and C may be decoding without understanding: see the meaning checks on the sentence reading record.
- **Speed.** Note where the student was when time ran out. IGCSE papers are long; a student who is accurate but very slow will need reading practice and, possibly, an access arrangement assessment if there is a specific need.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Writing page. Choose one task, A or B, and tick the box. You can plan in the box, then write on the lines. You have 10 minutes. Write as much as you can." Do not explain the tasks or words.

The tasks. Task A (descriptive): describe a busy place (a market, a train station or a festival) so that the reader can see, hear and smell it. Task B (persuasive): an article for the school website on whether every student should volunteer for one week each year, with an opinion, reasons and examples. The plan is not marked.

Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 fall between the descriptions).

Criterion	0	2	4 (what a fluent 14 year old would do)
Content and organisation	Nothing relevant in English, or a few words copied from the task.	Relevant to the task; ideas in a sensible order but little developed; may be one block of text; the description is a list of things, or the article lists reasons without explaining them.	Well developed and clearly organised in paragraphs. Description: a clear sense of place built up through the senses, a viewpoint or mood, a shape (for example moving through the place, or from morning to night). Article: a clear position, reasons developed with examples, some awareness of the other side, a conclusion; written for website readers.
Vocabulary	Isolated words, or only words from the prompt.	Everyday words used correctly but repeated ("many people", "very busy", "good"); a few words chosen for effect; simple linking (and, but, because).	Wide and precise vocabulary chosen for effect (sounds, smells, movement; persuasive phrases); a range of linking words (however, moreover, as a result, although); some figurative language that works.
Grammar and sentences	No sentences.	Mostly simple sentences, some joined with and, but, because; frequent errors in verb forms, plurals and articles, but the meaning is clear.	A variety of sentence types used for effect, including complex sentences and some short sentences for impact; verb forms controlled; errors are rare and do not affect meaning.
Spelling and punctuation	Mostly impossible to read.	Common words spelt correctly; capital letters and full stops mostly correct; errors in less common words.	Almost all words spelt correctly, including ambitious ones; a range of punctuation (commas in lists and after openers, question marks, apostrophes, colons) used correctly.

Band by best fit, using the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, and the notes below. The total is a check, not a rule: as a rough guide, totals of 0 to 3 usually go with A, 4 to 7 with B, 8 to 10 with C, 11 to 13 with D and 14 to 16 with E.

Band	Writing at Year 10 entry
A	Name, isolated words or copied phrases; may write in Chinese.
B	A few short sentences on the topic, with frequent errors; meaning mostly clear.
C	A short connected piece (often 60 to 120 words) with some joined sentences; errors frequent but rarely block meaning; little paragraphing.
D	An organised piece (often 120 to 200 words) with paragraphs and a range of sentences; generally accurate with occasional errors; some varied vocabulary.
E	See below.

Band E writing at this age. A fluent 14 year old usually writes 180 to 280 words in 10 minutes, in paragraphs, with controlled, varied sentences, precise vocabulary chosen for its effect on the reader, and accurate spelling and punctuation. The description creates a mood rather than listing objects; the article argues, gives evidence and examples, and speaks directly to its reader. This is roughly the level a First Language English IGCSE course starts from.

What to look for

- Typical features of English from speakers of Chinese (missing articles, plural -s, past tense -ed, third person -s) are normal at bands C and D. Do not let them alone pull a well-organised, well-developed piece below D.
- A memorised opening ("Nowadays, with the development of society") or memorised essay phrases followed by very simple writing shows exam training more than fluency: band by what the student can produce independently.
- For IGCSE, the gap between the writing band and the other bands matters: writing is assessed in almost every subject. If writing is two bands below reading, name it in the summary.

3.4 Interview, speaking and sentence reading (15 minutes, 1:1)

Use `forms/Interview_Record_Y7_Y10` for the interview and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record` for the sentence reading. Both are in English.

- **Sentence reading first** (3 to 5 minutes). Year 10 starts at **Level 9 (sentence 25)**. Follow the start, going-back and stopping rules and the scoring on the record. It gives total points out of 72, an indicative reading age, meaning checks and a fluency rating. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1.
- **Interview** (about 10 minutes): choose questions from each block on the form, including **future plans and aspirations** and the **Year 10 only** questions about IGCSE subject choices and starting a two-year course in English. Use the easier and stretch prompts so that every student can show their best spoken English.
- **Speaking band:** circle it on the interview record, using the descriptors there, and copy it to the score summary below. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand.

4. Maths (20 minutes, 30 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Maths page. You have 20 minutes. Write your answers in the boxes and show your working. I can read any question to you in English. You may not use a calculator. Do as much as you can, and look at every page." The example box at the start of Section A shows what the command words Standard form, Expand, Make … the subject and Solve mean; it is there so that an English word does not hide maths the student knows.

Sections. Section A, **Number problems** (questions 1 to 7, 9 marks): calculation and algebra with no context. Section B, **Word problems and pictures** (questions 8 to 18, 21 marks): **word problems** (questions 8 to 11, 7 marks) and problems with diagrams, pictures and tables (questions 12 to 18, 14 marks). Questions 7 and 18(b) are ceiling items from the Year 10 (IGCSE) course; questions 1 and 8 are floor items.

Marking. M = method mark, A = accuracy mark (depends on the method), B = independent mark. A correct answer with no working gets full marks unless the scheme says otherwise. Units are not needed unless stated. Working in numbers and symbols is fine; any words must be in English.

What a Year 10 entrant may not have been taught. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually completed **Grade 8 (初二)**, so **algebra (expanding, factorising with common factors, indices, linear equations and simultaneous equations), Pythagoras and linear functions are often strong**. Chinese textbooks write a straight line as $y = kx + b$, not $y = mx + c$. Grade 9 topics **may not have been taught yet**: quadratic equations, similar triangles, trigonometry and probability with tree diagrams. Compound interest is often new too (primary school teaches simple interest). Use NT and judge whether the student would reach the expected band once taught: Grade 9 covers these topics, so a strong Grade 8 student usually catches up quickly.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
Section A	**Number problems**			
1	Negative numbers and order of operations (floor)	4	B1. An answer of 44 ((−8 − 3) × (−4)) shows the order of operations is not secure; −20 is a sign error.	Secure (Grade 7).
2	Standard form	4.6×10^6	B1. Do not accept 46×10^5.	Secure (Grade 7, 科学记数法).
3	Laws of indices	x^6	B1	Secure (Grade 8, 幂的运算).
4	Rearranging a formula	$x = (y + 5) \div 3$	B1. Accept $x = y/3 + 5/3$ and equivalents.	Secure (Grades 7 to 8).
5	Expanding double brackets	$x^2 + 2x - 8$	B2. B1 for $x^2 - 2x + 4x - 8$ with at most one error, or for $x^2 + 2x$ with a wrong number term.	Secure (Grade 8, 整式的乘法).

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
6	Simultaneous equations	$x = 4$, $y = 3$	M1 for adding the equations ($3x = 12$) or a correct substitution; A1 for both values. Both values found by trial and correct: 2.	Secure (Grade 7, 二元一次方程组).
7	Solving a quadratic by factorising (ceiling)	$x = 2$ or $x = 3$	B1 for both values. If $(x - 2)(x - 3)$ is seen without the solutions: 0, but note "factorises quadratics".	Grade 9 (一元二次方程): may not have been taught. Factorising $x^2 + px + q$ (十字相乘法) is taught in some Grade 8 classes only.
Section B	**Word problems**			
8	Percentage of an amount (one step)	180	B1	Secure (Grade 6).
9	Reverse percentage, money	¥450	M1 for 360 ÷ 0.8, or 360 ÷ 80 × 100, or "80% = 360"; A1 for 450. An answer of 432 (360 × 1.2) scores 0: it shows the student increased the sale price by 20% instead of working back.	Secure (Grade 6: finding the whole from a percentage).
10	Compound interest, money	¥5408	M1 for 5200 (after one year), or 5000×1.04^2, or 5000×1.0816; A1 for 5408. An answer of 5400 (simple interest) scores 0: note it.	Compound interest may not have been taught (primary teaches simple interest, 利率).
11	Average speed with a time calculation	280 km per hour	M1 for 4.5 hours, or 4 hours 30 minutes, or 270 minutes, or 1260 ÷ 4.5; A1 for 280. An answer of about 293 (using 4.3 hours) scores 0: a time conversion error.	Secure (primary and Grade 8 physics).
Section B	**Diagrams, pictures and tables**			
12	Circumference; volume of a cylinder	(a) 31.4 cm (b) 785 cm^3	B1 each. Accept 10π and 250π. (b) An answer of 3140 (using the diameter) scores 0.	Secure (Grade 6).
13	Pythagoras' theorem (shorter side)	6 m	M1 for $6.5^2 - 2.5^2$, or 42.25 – 6.25, or 36; A1 for 6. An answer near 7 (adding the squares) scores 0.	Secure (Grade 8, 勾股定理).
14	Gradient and y-intercept	$y = 2x - 3$	B1 for the gradient 2, B1 for the intercept –3 (each can be shown in a wrong equation, for example $y = 2x + 3$ scores 1).	Secure (Grade 8, 一次函数; the student may write k and b).
15	Estimated mean from grouped data	18.5 minutes	M1 for using the midpoints 5, 15, 25 and 35 (20 + 120 + 125 + 105 = 370) or 370 ÷ 20; A1 for 18.5. Using the upper class limits (470 ÷ 20 = 23.5) scores 0.	Usually secure: Grade 8 statistics uses class midpoints (组中值) to estimate a mean.
16	Similar triangles	12 cm	M1 for the scale factor 1.5, or 9 ÷ 6, or 8 × 9 ÷ 6; A1 for 12. An answer of 11 (adding 3) shows additive rather than multiplicative thinking.	Grade 9 (相似): may not have been taught, but ratio from primary school often helps.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
17	Tree diagram	(a) 0.8 (Monday not late), 0.8 (Tuesday not late after late), 0.2 and 0.8 (Tuesday after not late) (b) 0.04	(a) B1 for all four. (b) B1. Accept 4/100, 1/25, 4%. An answer of 0.4 (adding) scores 0.	Grade 9 (概率, 树状图): may not have been taught.
18	Trigonometry with given values	(a) 5.7 cm (b) 37°	(a) B1 for 5.7 (accept 5.74 or 10 × 0.57). (b) B1 for 37° (ceiling: finding an angle). An answer of 53° in (b) means opposite and adjacent were swapped.	Grade 9 (锐角三角函数): may not have been taught.

Totals: Section A / 9, Section B / 21 (of which word problems, questions 8 to 11: / 7). **Band guide** (provisional): 0 to 11: **1** Well below expected; 12 to 17: **2** Working towards; 18 to 25: **3** Expected; 26 to 30: **4** Greater depth. Every Year 10 topic in the blueprint is tested at least once.

What to look for

- **Number problems against word problems.** A student who scores well on Section A but poorly on the word problems (questions 8 to 11) may have an **English barrier rather than a maths difficulty**. Check by reading the word problem aloud in English, and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese (mark it L). If the student then solves it quickly, record the barrier. IGCSE maths papers are full of words, so this student needs maths vocabulary support, not a lower tier.
- **Strong responses** show secure algebra (Section A almost complete), clear working and correct units, and attempts at the Grade 9 topics. A student with 7 or more out of 9 in Section A is usually ready for the Extended (Higher) tier once the Grade 9 topics are taught (Section 6).
- **Weak responses** show errors on taught topics (negative numbers, percentages, equations, Pythagoras), not just on NT topics. If most of the lost marks are NT questions (7, 10, 16, 17, 18), write the likely band once taught in the summary.

5. Science (8 minutes, 10 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Science page. You have 8 minutes. I can read any question to you in English. Do as much as you can."

What a Year 10 entrant may not have been taught. In Chinese middle schools, biology runs from Grade 7, physics starts in Grade 8 (motion and speed, force, pressure, simple machines and efficiency) and chemistry only in Grade 9. A Year 10 entrant has usually done **biology and some physics but no chemistry**. Questions 6 and 7 may not have been taught: mark NT rather than reading this as weak science, and judge scientific thinking from question 4.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
1	Specialised cells	B (root hair cell)	B1	Usually secure (Grade 7 biology: cells, roots, blood).
2	Distance-time graph and speed	(a) He stopped (not moving) (b) 6 m/s	(a) B1: stopped; waiting; at traffic lights. Do not accept "going slowly". (b) B1 for 6 (1200 ÷ 200).	Secure (Grade 8 physics, 速度 and distance-time graphs).
3	Pressure	300 N/m²	B1. Accept 300 Pa. An answer of 1200 (600 × 2) scores 0.	Secure (Grade 8 physics, 压强).

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
4	Factors affecting photosynthesis: pattern, variables, evaluating a method	(a) The further away the lamp, the fewer bubbles (b) One control variable (c) One sensible improvement	(a) B1: must link both variables (closer means more bubbles is fine). (b) B1: the same pondweed, the same water temperature, the same volume of water, the same lamp or bulb, the same counting time. Do not accept "distance" or "number of bubbles". (c) B1: repeat each distance and find a mean; count for longer; collect and measure the gas instead of counting bubbles (bubbles differ in size); keep the temperature the same (the lamp heats the water).	Photosynthesis is secure (Grade 7 biology). Evaluating a method is less familiar: score what the student writes.
5	Efficiency	0.75	B1. Accept 75% and 3/4. An answer of 150 or 1.33 scores 0.	Usually secure (Grade 8 physics, 机械效率), although energy transfer diagrams may be new.
6	Atomic structure	7	B1 (3 protons + 4 neutrons). An answer of 3 (protons only) or 10 (all particles) scores 0.	Chemistry is Grade 9: may not have been taught.
7	Balancing an equation	2	B1	Chemistry is Grade 9: may not have been taught, but the particle picture lets a student count atoms.

Band guide (provisional): 0 to 3: **1**; 4 to 5: **2**; 6 to 8: **3**; 9 to 10: **4**. Look at the NT questions before deciding.

Not tested this year (not enough time): diffusion, groups in the periodic table, rates of reaction, energy resources, waves, DNA and inheritance. Ask about them in the interview if they matter for subject choices.

What to look for

- **Working scientifically** (question 4) is the best guide to IGCSE science readiness: a student who describes a pattern, names a control variable and suggests a real improvement is ready for practical work in English, even with chemistry NT.
- **An English barrier** looks like: blank or wrong answers that become right when you read the question aloud. Science vocabulary in English (specialised, efficiency, variable, mass number) is often the gap: note the words the student did not know.
- **Strong responses** use units (m/s, N/m^2) and give precise answers in question 4 (for example "repeat three times and calculate a mean").

6. Readiness for IGCSE

This section is guidance for the school to confirm, against its own admissions policy, the IGCSE syllabuses it offers (for example Cambridge IGCSE or Pearson Edexcel International GCSE), the entry requirements of its own sixth form or diploma programme, and the support it can provide. It is not a set of fixed rules. Fill in the score summary (Section 7) first, then read the results together.

English is the gateway. Every IGCSE subject except other languages is taught and examined in English, with long texts, extended written answers and command words such as describe, explain and evaluate. Look at the overall English band, and most closely at **reading and writing**, because the exams depend on them. Academic English usually develops more slowly than conversation: as a planning assumption, a student rarely moves up more than about one band a year in academic reading and writing, even with good support. A student at band C at the start of Year 10 may still be at C or D when the exams come.

English band	What it usually means for IGCSE study in English	English course that may fit best
A New to English	Cannot yet follow subject lessons in English. Direct entry to a two-year IGCSE course is not usually advisable (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9).	A preparatory or foundation route, or a later start, if the school has one.
B Early acquisition	Can follow simple, supported lessons, but IGCSE texts and exam questions will be very hard for most of Year 10.	Only with an English as a Second Language course, a reduced subject load and close review, if the school's policy allows.
C Developing competence	Can follow most lessons with support; subject vocabulary and extended writing will slow progress. Maths and the sciences are usually more accessible than essay-based subjects.	**English as a Second Language**, with support for subject language.
D Competent	Usually ready for IGCSE courses taught in English, with some support for academic writing.	English as a Second Language at the higher level, or First Language English if reading **and** writing are strong D or E. Check with the English department.
E Fluent	Ready for IGCSE study in English.	**First Language English** (and English Literature, if offered).

What English band does a student realistically need? As a working guide for the school to test: **band C or above in reading and writing**, with listening and speaking at C or above, to follow IGCSE courses taught in English with support, and **band D or above** to follow them with little extra support. Review these thresholds once the first groups of students have taken their IGCSEs.

English as a Second Language or First Language English? First Language English assumes the reading and writing of a fluent speaker: analysing how writers use language, and writing at length for different purposes. It is usually the better fit only when reading (Part C 6 or more) and writing (band E, or a strong D) are both near fluent. For most students at band C or D, an English as a Second Language course is the better fit: it teaches the reading, writing, listening and speaking needed for study, and a good grade is more achievable. Check what the school's sixth form, diploma programme and likely universities ask for, because some ask for a particular course or grade; tell the family early.

Maths. Band 3 or 4 with a secure Section A (7 or more out of 9) suggests the **Extended (Higher) tier**. NT marks on the Grade 9 topics (quadratics, similar triangles, trigonometry, tree diagrams, compound interest) are expected for a Grade 8 student and are usually caught up quickly. A band 2 with errors on taught topics suggests the Core (Foundation) tier at first, with a learning plan and a review after one term. A band 1 that NT and English do not explain (low on taught topics too) needs further assessment before a decision (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9). A large gap between number problems and word problems points to English support in maths, not a lower tier.

Science. No chemistry is normal for this age group (questions 6 and 7 NT). Look at question 4 and the biology and physics questions. Strong science (band 3 or 4) with English D or E may suit separate sciences; with English B or C, a combined or co-ordinated science course, or fewer science subjects in the first year, may be more manageable while English grows.

Reading the results together (examples of common profiles)

Profile	What it suggests	A possible plan (for the school to confirm)
English D or E; maths 3 or 4; science 3 or 4 (allowing for NT)	Ready for a full IGCSE programme.	Full subject load; English course by the table above; Extended maths.
English C; maths 3 or 4, with word problems well below number problems	Strong maths; English is the barrier.	English as a Second Language with subject-language support; Extended maths with vocabulary support; not too many essay-based subjects in Year 10.
English C; maths 2 with NT on Grade 9 topics; chemistry NT	Likely to manage with support.	English as a Second Language; a learning plan for the NT maths topics and for chemistry; maths tier decided after a six-week review.

Profile	What it suggests	A possible plan (for the school to confirm)
English B, any maths and science	The English gap is too wide for most IGCSE content in two years without intensive support.	Offer only with an English as a Second Language course, a reduced subject load and close review, if the school's policy allows; otherwise discuss a preparatory route or a later start (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9).
English D or E; maths band 1 on taught topics	Not an English issue.	Further assessment before a decision (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9): look for gaps in earlier learning or a possible learning need. If an offer follows, maths support and the Core tier at first.
Strong results, but the interview shows the IGCSE plan is the family's, not the student's	Readiness is not only academic.	Talk with the family and student about subject choices and workload before an offer (interview record, suitability strands). A serious mismatch, or any strand rated 1, goes to the head of section before any offer.

Use the Year 10 interview questions (IGCSE subject choices, managing a two-year course in English) to judge whether the student's plans are realistic and their own. Record the readiness judgement in the assessor's comment below and on the Candidate Summary and Decision.

7. Score summary

Copy to `forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`.

Part	Score	Band	Notes (NT, L, access arrangements, behaviour)
Listening	___ / 16 (Part A ___ / 8, Part B ___ / 8)	A B C D E	
Reading paper	___ / 24 (A ___ / 8, B ___ / 8, C ___ / 8)	A B C D E	
Sentence reading (shared record)	points ___ / 72; reading age _____	indicative: A B C D E	Meaning checks: Fluency:
Writing (task A or B)	___ / 16 (content ___, vocabulary ___, grammar ___, spelling and punctuation ___)	A B C D E	
Speaking (from the interview)		A B C D E	
Maths	___ / 30 (A ___ / 9, B ___ / 21, of which word problems ___ / 7)	1 2 3 4	NT: L:
Science	___ / 10	1 2 3 4	NT: L:
Overall English (the band most skills sit in; name any skill two or more bands lower)		A B C D E	
Readiness for IGCSE (Section 6)	English course: ESL / First Language / to decide Maths tier: Extended / Core / to decide	Ready / Ready with support / Not yet	

Assessor's comment (strengths, English barrier or not, NT topics and the likely maths and science band once taught, readiness for IGCSE, anything to follow up):

Assessor signature and date _____

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: assessor record

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Age today (years:months)	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Assessor	

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 10. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this record, a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening).

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"

Code	Error	Example
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (mark them, but do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said in the notes. Patterns in the notes (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in the record). Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Record ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood). The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is recorded ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Record

Level 1 (sentences 1 to 3)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
1	I can see a red bus.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
2	The cat sat on my bed.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
3	Dad has a big hat.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 2 (sentences 4 to 6)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
6	They like to play in the park.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 3 (sentences 7 to 9)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 4 (sentences 10 to 12)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 5 (sentences 13 to 15)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 6 (sentences 16 to 18)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 7 (sentences 19 to 21)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 8 (sentences 22 to 24)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 9 (sentences 25 to 27)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 10 (sentences 28 to 30)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 11 (sentences 31 to 33)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 12 (sentences 34 to 36)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Total points	/ 72
Reading age	
Actual age (years:months)	
Difference (reading age minus actual age)	
Meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓)	
Fluency rating (1 to 4)	
Patterns noticed	

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and

structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 10 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 10
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Copy to the Candidate Summary: total points, reading age, actual age, meaning checks, fluency, indicative band, one line on patterns.

Student interview and suitability record: Years 7 to 10

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Interviewer	
Others present (for example receiving homeroom teacher; Chinese-speaking colleague)	

About 15 minutes, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the student's spoken English (the speaking band), to get to know the student (interests, learning, wellbeing, **future plans and aspirations**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme. It opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (start Level 6 for Year 7, 7 for Year 8, 8 for Year 9, 9 for Year 10; record on `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record.md`).

How to ask. Start with the main question. If the student struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, or a choice). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. This lets every student show their best English. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. Answers must be in English.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a student tells you something that worries you about their safety or wellbeing, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Sentence reading (3 to 5 minutes)

Total points ___ / 72 Reading age _____ Meaning checks ___ Fluency ___ (details on the sentence reading record)

2. Questions (10 minutes)

Choose about two questions from each block. Tick the ones you used and write short notes: what they said, and how they said it.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch	Notes
Warm-up	Tell me a little about yourself.	What is your name? How old are you? Where do you live?	What would your friends say about you?	
	How did you travel here today?	Did you come by car?	What do you like or dislike about your city?	
School and learning	Tell me about your school now.	Do you like your school? What is your favourite subject?	What is the biggest difference you expect between your school and ours?	
	Which subject do you find hardest? What do you do when work is difficult?	Is maths easy or hard for you?	Tell me about a time you kept going when something was hard.	
	How do you learn English now?	Do you have English lessons? Do you read in English?	What helps you most when you learn new words?	
	How do you feel about learning all your subjects in English?	Are you worried, excited, or both?	What will be hardest, and how will you deal with it?	
Interests	What do you enjoy doing outside school?	Do you like sport, music or art?	What have you achieved in it that you are proud of?	

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch	Notes
	Tell me about a book, film or game you enjoyed.	Do you like reading? What kind of books?	Why did it stay in your mind?	
	Do you take part in any clubs, competitions, volunteering or service?	Do you help at home or in your community?	What did you learn from it?	
Friends and wellbeing	Who do you spend time with at school?	Do you have good friends?	How do you help a friend who is having a bad day?	
	How do you relax when you feel tired or stressed?	What makes you happy?	How do you balance study, activities and rest?	
	How many classes or tutoring sessions do you have after school?	Do you have classes at the weekend?	How do you feel about how busy you are?	
Future plans and aspirations	What would you like to do in the future?	Do you have a dream job?	What steps would get you there?	
	Where would you like to study after school, and what would you study?	China or another country?	Why does that place or subject interest you?	
	Why do you want to join the international programme? Whose idea was it?	Is it your idea or your parents' idea?	What do you hope it will give you that your school now does not?	
	What kind of person do you want to be at our school?	Do you want to join clubs?	What could you give to our school community?	
Values (choose one)	A classmate asks to copy your homework. What do you do?	Is it OK to copy homework?	Why does honesty matter in learning?	
	A new student is sitting alone at lunch. What do you do?	Would you talk to them?	Why might someone find it hard to join a group?	
Opinion (to hear extended speaking)	Should students have homework every day? Why, or why not?	Do you like homework?	What would be a better system? Give an example.	
	Should phones be allowed in school?	Do you use a phone at school now?	What are the strongest arguments on the other side?	
Year 10 only	Which IGCSE subjects would you like to take, and why?	Which subjects do you like best?	How do they connect to your future plans?	
	The IGCSE course takes two years. How will you manage starting a new course in English?	Will it be hard for you?	What support will you look for, and from whom?	
Questions for us	What would you like to ask me about the school?	Do you have any questions?		

3. Speaking band

Circle the band that fits best. Use the evidence from the whole interview.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	Little or no spoken English, or single memorised words and phrases ("I am fine"). Relies on Chinese, gesture or silence. Understands very little unless supported.
B Early acquisition	Short answers and simple memorised sentences on familiar topics (family, school, likes). Frequent errors in word order, verbs and plurals. Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions.
C Developing competence	Answers most main questions with connected sentences, using "because", "but", "so". Errors are frequent but meaning is usually clear. Vocabulary is everyday; searches for words on less familiar topics. Can give a short opinion with a reason.
D Competent	Speaks at length on most questions, explains and gives examples, handles the stretch prompts with some effort. Errors are occasional and rarely affect meaning. Some subject and abstract vocabulary.
E Fluent	Speaks as fluently and accurately as a fluent English speaker of the same age. Handles abstract and hypothetical questions easily, with a wide vocabulary.

Speaking band: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E** Listening in conversation (how much of your English they understood): **A** **B** **C** **D** **E**

Notes on pronunciation and intelligibility (pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand):

4. Suitability

Rate each strand from what you saw and heard. **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence: a short quotation or something you observed.

Strand	What strong looks like	Rating	Evidence
Attitude to learning and resilience	Wants to learn, has a go, keeps going when work is hard, talks about effort and improvement	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Curiosity and engagement	Asks questions, shows interest in ideas beyond the textbook, enjoys discussion	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Social and emotional readiness	Relaxed or able to settle, makes eye contact (allowing for culture and shyness), talks about friends, manages feelings, ready for a change of school	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Independence and self-management	Organises themselves, can describe how they study, manages time and activities, will ask for help	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Values and conduct	Kind, honest and respectful in the interview and in the values question	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Readiness for English-medium learning	Motivated to learn in English, willing to speak even with mistakes, has strategies for new words	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Clarity and ownership of future plans	Has thought about what comes next, the plans are their own as well as the family's, understands why the international programme fits	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	

Boarding readiness (only if the student will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness, experience of being away from home. Rating ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 Evidence:

5. Anything to follow up

Area	Tick	Notes
Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision)	☐	
Wellbeing (for example anxiety, low mood, very heavy workload, sleep)	☐	
Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)	☐	
Medical or dietary	☐	
Mismatch between the student's wishes and the family's plans	☐	

6. Receiving homeroom teacher (optional)

If the student's likely homeroom teacher meets them, note first impressions and what the student would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy who speaks Chinese, a vocabulary book for each subject, a quiet check-in each morning).

Interviewer signature and date

Parent conversation record

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Staff member	
Parents or carers present	
Language used (and interpreter if any)	

About 15 minutes. Hold it while the student does the written tasks with another adult, or straight after. Use the family's preferred language; a Chinese-speaking colleague should lead or interpret if the staff member does not speak Chinese. The aim is a two-way conversation: to understand the child and the family's hopes, to explain how the international programme works, and to check that what the family wants matches what the school offers. Do not discuss the assessment results on the day.

1. Why the international programme?

Question	Notes
Why are you looking for a place in the international programme, and why now?	
What do you know about how the programme works (lessons in English, the UK-style curriculum, assessment, homework, activities)?	
Whose idea is the move, and how does your child feel about it?	

2. Schooling so far

Question	Notes
Schools attended, years, and type (Chinese mainstream, bilingual, international, overseas)	
Any year repeated or skipped? Any long gaps?	
Why is the child leaving their current school?	
Student registration (学籍): where is it held now, and what will happen to it? (admissions office to give the school's position)	
School reports, certificates and any assessments the family can share	

3. Languages

Question	Notes
Which languages are spoken at home, and by whom?	
How has the child learnt English so far (school lessons from which grade, classes outside school, tutor, online, time abroad, English-speaking carer)? About how many hours a week?	
Does the child read in English at home? In Chinese?	
How will the family support English at home (reading, media, activities), and support Chinese if that matters to the family?	

4. Learning, health and development

Ask gently and explain why: the school wants to have the right support ready from the first day.

Question	Notes
What is your child good at? What do they enjoy most?	
Has any teacher or doctor ever raised a concern about learning, speech and language, attention, behaviour, hearing or vision? Any assessments or reports?	
Any extra help at the current school?	
Medical conditions, allergies, medication (also on the school medical form)	
For young children: speech in Chinese for their age, toilet and self-care, sleep	

5. Wellbeing and the week

Question	Notes
How would you describe your child's personality? How do they cope with change?	
Friendships: does your child make friends easily?	
A typical weekday and weekend: after-school classes, tutoring, sport, music, screen time, sleep	
Any big changes in the family recently (a move, a new baby, a parent working away)? Share only what you are comfortable sharing.	

6. Expectations and partnership

Question	Notes
What would make this a successful first year for your child?	
What do you expect from the school (homework, reports, communication, class rankings, exam results)? Explain how the school reports progress and how it communicates.	
How does the family feel about co-curricular activities, sport, arts, service and wellbeing as part of education, not just exam subjects?	
Learning in a new language takes time: explain what is typical (social English often within one to two years; the English needed for academic work often takes several years) and how the school supports it. How does the family feel about this?	
How would the family like to be involved (events, meetings, volunteering)?	

7. Future plans

Question	Notes
What are your hopes for your child in the long term (university, country, career)?	
Do you plan to stay in the international programme through to the end of school?	
Explain the programme's pathway (for example IGCSE, then the sixth form programme) and how it differs from the 中考 and 高考 route, using the admissions office's wording. Does the family understand that moving back to the national exam route later may not be straightforward?	
Year 10 applicants: which IGCSE subjects does the student hope to take? Explain that IGCSE is a two-year course starting in Year 10.	

8. Boarding (only if the child will board)

Question	Notes
Has the child stayed away from home before (camps, boarding, family)? How did it go?	
How independent are they with daily routines, sleep and belongings?	
How will the family keep in touch, and how often will the child go home?	

9. Questions from the family

10. Staff view

	Rating	Notes
Match between the family's expectations and what the programme offers	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Family's willingness to work in partnership with the school	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Information to follow up (reports, medical, assessments, 学籍)		

1 Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong.

Consent. The parent or carer agrees that the school may contact the current school (homeroom teacher) for a reference: **Yes** ☐ **No** ☐

Parent or carer signature _____

Staff signature and date _____

Candidate summary and decision

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Year group applied for	
Current school	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

Complete within two working days, from the assessor booklet, reading records, interview record, parent conversation and homeroom teacher reference. The bands guide a professional decision; they are not a pass mark (guide, Sections 6 to 9).

1. English profile

Skill	Evidence (scores)	Band
Listening	Listening task ___ / ___ ; listening in conversation	**A B C D E**
Speaking	Interview (and picture talk, Years 1 to 3)	**A B C D E**
Reading	Years 1 to 3: Early Reading Screen book band _____ accuracy ___% questions ___ ; phonics words ___ / 40 ; letter sounds ___ / 26 and ___ / 18 ; tricky words ___ / 20. Years 4 to 10: reading paper ___ / 24 (A ___ B ___ C ___)	**A B C D E**
Reading aloud	Sentence reading: points ___ / 72 ; reading age _____ ; actual age _____ ; meaning checks ___ ; fluency ___	indicative **A B C D E**
Writing	Writing task ___ / 16	**A B C D E**
Overall English	The band most of the four skills sit in. If one skill is two or more bands below the others, say which.	**A B C D E**

A New to English, **B** Early acquisition, **C** Developing competence, **D** Competent, **E** Fluent (comparable to a fluent English speaker of the same age).

2. Maths and science

	Score	Band	Number problems (Years 7 to 10 v2: fluency)	Word problems (v2: word questions)	Applied (v2 only)	Not yet taught (NT)	Language support (L)
Maths	___ / ___	**1 2 3 4**	___ / ___	___ / ___	___ / 12		
Science (Years 5 to 10)	___ / ___	**1 2 3 4**					

1 Well below expected (Years 7 to 10 v2: below expected), **2** Working towards, **3** Expected, **4** Greater depth. The v2 papers are harder, so their band boundaries are lower (guide and booklets). A student who does well on number problems but poorly on word problems may have an English barrier rather than a maths difficulty. In the Years 7 to 10 v2 papers, a student strong in fluency and word questions but weak in applied problems needs teaching in problem solving, not more content. Questions marked NT score 0; say whether the student is likely to reach the expected band once taught.

Year 10 only: readiness for IGCSE (Year 10 assessor booklet, Section 6). English course: ☐ First Language ☐ English as a Second Language ☐ to decide. Maths tier: ☐ Extended ☐ Core ☐ to decide. Overall: ☐ Ready ☐ Ready with support ☐ Not yet.

Assessor's comment on maths and science (strengths, gaps, NT topics, English barrier or not):

3. Suitability

Source	Summary	Concerns (any strand rated 1)
Student interview (strands rated 1 to 4)		
Parent conversation (match of expectations, partnership)		
Previous homeroom teacher reference		
School reports and documents		
Follow-ups (special educational needs, wellbeing, medical, safeguarding referral made)		

4. Recommendation

Use the decision guide in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9. Tick one.

	Recommendation
☐	**Offer.** Ready to join the year group with normal class support.
☐	**Offer with English support.** Ready academically; needs a planned English programme (state the level below).
☐	**Offer with a learning plan.** Needs catch-up in named maths or science topics, or other planned support; review date set.
☐	**Further assessment before a decision.** For example a second visit, a trial day, a specialist assessment, or more information from the family or school.
☐	**Unable to offer at this time.** The programme cannot meet the student's needs now. Give the reason and, where possible, what would change the decision.

Year group confirmed: _____ (by age: yes / no; if no, give the reason and who approved it)

5. Support from the first day (if offered)

Area	Plan
English support level	☐ Intensive (new to English) ☐ Timetabled support lessons ☐ In-class support and monitoring ☐ None needed
Maths and science catch-up	
Reading (book band or reading age to start from)	
Pastoral (buddy, homeroom check-ins, boarding support)	
Information for the homeroom teacher	
Review date (for example after six weeks)	

6. Sign-off

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Assessor			
Head of section			
Admissions			
Outcome told to the family (start with the child's strengths)			